AUSTRALASIAN RECORD

"Sound an alarm: for the day of the Lord cometh, for it is nigh at hand."

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Registered at the General Post Office, Sydney, for transmission by Post as a Newspaper.

Send Rain, O Lord

"Send rain," the parched earth seems to cry,
While flowers and grasses fade and die,
In summer's scorching heat.
The leaves of shrubs and mighty trees
Are falling with each passing breeze,
While nought remains the eye to please
In fields where sun-rays beat.

The cattle of a thousand hills
In vain have sought, where flowing rills
Once quenched their frequent thirst;
The bleating flocks, which thither hie,
Find nought but sand all parched and dry.
"Send rain, O Lord," all seem to cry,
"For man's sins we are cursed."

And shall not man take up the strain
And cry to God, yea, not in vain?
For it is time to pray:
"Lord, for the latter rain we plead,
In this our time of direful need.
Oh! by Thy Spirit's power indeed
Give grace for this dark day."

W. R. CARSWELL.

The Spirit of a Christian

THERE are too many among those who profess to be followers of Christ who seek to excuse their own defects by magnifying the errors of others. The highest evidence of nobility in a Christian is self-control. We should copy the example of Jesus; for when He was reviled, He reviled not again, but committed Himself to Him that judgeth righteously. Our Redeemer met insult and mockery with uncomplaining silence. All the cruel taunts of the murderous throng who exulted in His humiliation and trial in the judgment-hall, could not bring from Him one look or word of resentment or impatience. He was the majesty of heaven, and in His pure breast there dwelt no room for the spirit of retaliation, but only for pity and love. There is a time when silence is golden. We should always copy the life of Jesus; for we are to be like Him. He loves us notwithstanding our defects and shortcomings. Let us not think that one of the graces of Christ is portrayed with no lesson to us in its portrayal. Pure love thinketh no evil. When we constantly imagine that we are not appreciated, and watch for slights, we do ourselves and others great harm. We must forget self in loving service for others.

If you think your brother has injured you, go to him in kindness and love, and you may come to an understanding and to reconciliation. When you deal with the erring, you should always keep in mind the fact that you are dealing with Christ in the person of His saints. Go to your brother whom you think in the wrong, and lovingly talk with him alone; if you succeed in settling the trouble, you have gained your brother without exposing his frailties, and the settlement between you has been the covering of a multitude of sins from the observation of others. Others will not need to know of your difficulty, and thus be put on the alert to watch with suspicion everything the one you think at fault may do, and put a wrong construction on his motives.

"I say unto you, that likewise joy shall be in heaven over one sinner that repenteth, more than over ninety and nine just persons, which need no repentance." If the sinner repents because of your kind and loving admonition, work has been done for eternity. There is great need of carrying out the instruction of Christ in a definite manner, acting up to the word of our Master. This is living the law of God. In thus dealing with our brethren, we may make an impression on others that will never fade from their minds. We may not remember some act of kindness which we do, it may fade from our memory; but eternity will bring out in all its brightness, every act done for the salvation of souls, every word spoken for the comfort of God's children; and these deeds done for Christ's sake will be a part of our joy through all eternity. When we pursue toward our brethren any course save that of kindness and courtesy, we pursue an unchristian course. We should manifest courtesy at home, in the church, and in our intercourse with all men. But especially we should manifest compassion and respect for those who are giving their lives to the cause of God. We should exercise that precious love that suffereth long and is kind; that envieth not, that vaunteth not itself, is not puffed up, doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not its own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil. God would have His servants always appear at their best, both at home and in society; and where Jesus reigns in the heart, there will be sweet love, and we shall be tender and true to one another. It

takes special watchfulness to keep the affections alive, and our hearts in a condition where we shall be sensible of the good that exists in the hearts of others. If we do not watch on this point, Satan will put his jealousy into our souls; he will put his glasses before our eyes, that we may see the actions of our brethren in a distorted light. Instead of looking critically upon our brethren, we should turn our eyes within, and be ready to discover the objectionable traits of our own character. As we have a proper realization of our own mistakes and failures, the mistakes of others will sink into insignificance.

Satan is an accuser of the brethren. He is on the watch for every error, no matter how small, that he may have something on which to found an accusation. Keep off Satan's side. It is true that you should give no occasion for faultfinding. A moment's petulance, a single gruff answer, the want of Christian politeness and courtesy in some small matter, may result in the loss of friends, in the loss of influence. God would have you appear at your best under all circumstances, in the presence of those who are inferior to you as well as in the presence of equals and superiors. We are to be followers of Christ at all times, seeking His honour, seeking to rightly represent Him in every way, that we may be lights in the world, showing forth the praises of Him who has called us out of darkness into His marvellous light. We are not to exalt our own opinions above those of others. If our ideas are superior to those of others, it will be made manifest without special effort on our part. People of discernment will not fail to realize and appreciate the fact, and we shall receive the credit to which we are entitled. God bids us come to Him for wisdom, that we may shed the quickening influence of the Holy Spirit upon others, not the influence of own high opinion of ourselves. We are to come to God for His grace, that we may magnify and honour Him, not praise ourselves, but be able to impart new and noble impulses to those around us. God is taking account of all we do and say in seeking to educate men to lift their hearts to Him in gratitude and praise. Let self drop out of sight, and let Jesus appear as the One altogether lovely. We should seek to live for His glory alone, not that men may praise us. We should seek to do the work of God in all humility, in meekness and lowliness of heart, working as Christ worked, and angels will watch over us, and carry the tidings of our faithfulness to God and man, even to the courts of light.

MRS. E. G. WHITE.

Give and Live

Forever the sun is pouring gold
On a hundred worlds that beg and borrow;
His warmth he squanders on summits cold,
His wealth on the homes of want and sorrow;
To withhold his largess or precious light
Is to bury himself in eternal night.
To give
Is to live.

The flower blooms not for itself at all,
Its joy is the joy that diffuses;
Of beauty and balm it is prodigal,
And it lives in the life it freely loses;
No choice for the rose but glory or doom,
To exhale or smother, to wither or bloom.
To deny
Is to die.

The seas lend silvery rays to the land,
The land its sapphire streams to the ocean;
Though heart sends blood to the brain of command,
The brain to the heart its lightning motion;
And over and over we wield our breath,
Till the mirror is dry and images death.
To live
Is to give.

He is dead whose hand is not open wide
To help the need of a human brother;
He doubles the length of his lifelong ride
Who of his fortune gives to another;
And a thousand million lives are his
Who carries the world in his sympathies.
To deny
Is to die.

—*Selected.*

Vila, New Hebrides

WHILE making a trip on the steamer among the northern islands of this group, I was favourably impressed with a certain place. Not being able to reach it by taking the steamer, Brother Carr and I chartered a seven-ton auxiliary schooner. We left on January 19. Our trip to the place was filled with changes and some excitement, as we ran into a number of squalls and a small hurricane. After looking over the place we were well satisfied with it. It impressed us as being the property for which we have long been praying. All our minds had centered here, and now that we have seen it, and examined it, and have asked direction from Him who never errs in counsel, it seems as though we have been led forth by the right way to a city of habitation.

The people in that part are all naked heathen, and cannibalism is still practised. The people seemed pleased to think that we might come and live among them, and said that they would be glad to have us.

At this place the engine of the boat broke down, and we attempted to sail back against strong head winds, seas, and currents. We travelled only ten miles in nine days. The decks of the boat leaked badly, so we had to find what shelter we could on shore, and sleep upon the ground, which was quite damp from the rain. While anchored at a small island, the Lord sent the *Makambo* along, which picked us up and brought us back to Vila. Shortly after getting aboard the steamer, Brother Carr had a severe attack of malaria. He has had attacks right along since, which have made him quite weak and emaciated. Since reaching home he is looking better, and the attacks are not so severe.

On this trip Brother Carr was able to treat a number of sick people, and I preached my first sermon to the natives.

Upon his arrival at home Brother Carr was met by a bright, new Carr, which contributed to a most pleasant home-coming. Both Sister Carr and her baby boy are doing nicely.

Our wives had been made very anxious and were preparing for the worst, for all felt sure that our craft would not stand the storm we had passed through. The people were talking of sending out the government steamer to look for us. You may be sure there was a thanksgiving service upon our arrival. The Lord is indeed good, and in Him we live, move, and have our being.

We are now negotiating with the owner for the land, and hope shortly to have something definite. We ask an interest in your prayers, that God may help us to make no mistakes in the work here.

C. H. PARKER.

"Go make thy garden as fair as thou canst,
Thou workest never alone,
Perhaps he whose plot is next to thine,
Will see it and mend his own."

MEDICAL

The Sydney Sanitarium

THIS institution established by God, is purely and simply for the glory of His name, and the spread of the third angel's message through the great health reform movement. It is also our medical training institution for the whole of Australia, and here the truth is brought very prominently and forcibly before the people. The institution has been richly blessed of God during the past few months, and quite a number of old patrons have returned, and we have made many new friends. With very few exceptions, all have been very pleased with the attention received and the benefit gained during their stay at the institution. The numerous letters received from expatients testify not only to physical health, but to spiritual blessings received.

The 1913 nurses' class opened on January 1, and studies commenced about three weeks later. There are twelve members enrolled. This will form a class of eight young ladies and four young men.

Doctors Sherwin and Freeman and Matron Shannon are paying particular attention this year to class studies, and the young people entering the institution will be specially favoured in this respect, the curriculum having been revised and brought right up to date. Brother Carswell continues to conduct the Bible classes.

It is not too early for young people who contemplate giving their lives to medical missionary work, to begin to plan for next year's class. We are living in busy times, and the weeks and months fly quickly by. Before entering this branch of the Lord's work, there are statements in the Testimonies that might be profitably considered.

What evidence have we that God has any special design in our sanitarium work?

The Lord, years ago, gave me special light in regard to the establishment of a health institution where the sick could be treated on altogether different lines from those followed in any other institution in our world. It was to be founded and conducted on Bible principles, as the Lord's instrumentality, and it was to be in His hands, one of the most effective agencies for giving light to the world. It was God's purpose that it should stand forth with scientific ability, and with moral and spiritual power, and as a faithful sentinel of reform in all its bearings.

Is God particular as to who labour therein?

All who should act a part in it were to be reformers, having respect to its principles, and heeding the light of health reform shining upon us as a people.

What is to be the fruit of sanitarium life?

In our sanitariums, the sick and suffering are to be led to realize their need of spiritual help as well as physical restoration. They are to be given every advantage for the restoration of physical health: and they should be shown also what it means to be blessed with the light and life of Christ, and what it means to be bound up with Him. They are to be led to see that the grace of God in the soul uplifts the whole being. And in no better way can they learn of Christ's life than by seeing it revealed in the lives of His followers.

What particular advantage is there in connecting with the sanitarium, and receiving a training in medical missionary work?

He who puts on the armour to war a good warfare, will gain greater and greater ability as he strives to perfect his knowledge of God, working in harmony with the plan God has laid down for the perfect development of the physical, mental, and spiritual powers.

Are there any temptations in God's institutions, and what are the characteristics necessary to guard against them?

The workers in our sanitariums are continually exposed to temptations. They are brought into contact with unbelievers, and those who are not sound in faith will be harmed by the contact. But those who are abiding in Christ, will meet unbelievers as He met them, refusing to be drawn from their allegiance, but always ready to speak a word in season, always ready to sow the seeds of truth. They will watch unto prayer, firmly maintaining their integrity, and daily showing the consistency of their religion.

How should those who contemplate devoting their life as medical missionaries, feel toward the work?

They should appreciate the opportunity of so close a connection with the heavenly instrumentalities, and should feel that they are highly privileged in being permitted to give to the Lord's institution their ability, their service, and their unwearying vigilance.

Undoubtedly those who give themselves to this work are following a high and holy calling, by ministering to the sick and preparing themselves for further usefulness and responsibility in the last days of this world's history.

Let God's people everywhere pray and work for this institution, especially for the faculty, who have the training of so many young people, combined with many other arduous duties.

G. S. FISHER.

The Christchurch Sanitarium

THE work of this institution has now been carried on for about thirteen years, with many and varied experiences financially and otherwise. There have been times in its history when to all human appearance it would seem impossible for the work to continue any longer, but at each crucial stage the way was opened so that the work did not have to stop. And so it has continued till the present time, witnessing for the principles that gave it birth in relieving the suffering to which flesh is heir, and in testifying for the truth for this time.

There are many in this Dominion who have cause to thank the Lord for having had the opportunity of coming to the sanitarium, not only for the physical benefits received, but also for the spiritual. This institution has been instrumental, as others have been, in reaching some who otherwise probably would never have heard the truth. I will cite an instance or two:

A young commercial traveller, whom I had met on previous occasions, arrived in this city suffering with an acute and dangerous trouble, and came to be nursed and treated. The Lord wonderfully blessed the means used for his recovery. During this time I had an opportunity to read to him the truths contained in our books. He listened very attentively, remarking that those were the very things he was wanting to know and understand. As the days passed by and he began to improve, he said to me: "Now I know why I have been sick. The Lord has brought me here to make a Seventh-day Adventist of me." After he left us, he gave the institution a useful present for furnishing purposes, and has since united with our people. He was too busy at other times to give attention to God's claims on him, so no doubt the Lord used those means for bringing him to see his duty to his Creator.

I hope to see him become an active worker for the Lord one of these days.

We had a young woman as a patient who had fully made up her mind that she had no cause for considering the Sabbath and other truths held by us as a people; but after spending a few weeks here, she was led to consider the question. She is now an active worker in the cause of present truth.

There are also others who are watching us. While visiting in a distant town, I called on a woman who had been a patient, and who in the course of our conversation wanted to know how we managed to get such a number of workers together in one place who work so harmoniously. "I never saw the like," she said, "not an unpleasant word did I hear all the time I was there." To my mind, such experiences emphasize the fact that we are indeed spectacles to angels and to men. I then had an opportunity to explain to her more fully the motive actuating our workers, which I think gave her food for further thought. I am glad to state that financially we have been able to keep on the right side of the ledger for several years, when summed up as a whole.

G. A. BRANDSTATER.

Quarrelling

IF anything in the world will make a man feel bad, except pinching his fingers in the crack of a door, it is a quarrel. No man fails to think less of himself after than he did before; it degrades him in the eyes of others, and, what is worse, tends to blunt his sensibilities, and increase his irritability. The truth is, that the more peaceably and quietly we get on, the better for our neighbours. In nine cases out of ten, the better course is, if a man cheats you, to quit dealing with him; if he slanders you, take care to live down his slanders. Let such persons alone, for there is nothing better than this way of dealing with those who injure us.—*Hilton.*

IT is easier and much safer to sow clean and good seed in the hearts of your children than to pluck up the weeds afterward.—*Mrs. E. G. White.*

THE mind gradually adapts itself to the subject upon which it is allowed to dwell.

MISSIONARY CAMPAIGN

Letters from Lighthouse Keepers

THE Queensland Tract Society has been writing and sending literature to keepers of lighthouses on the Queensland coast. The following are two of many letters of appreciation received from these lonely people:

We are pleased to hear from your society, and are grateful for the interest you take in sending reading matter to the out-of-the-way places on the coast. I thank you for the *Signs of the Times*, it is the best of all the papers I get, and contains truth for to-day. Should you send any religious papers we would be very glad to read them and pass them on to our neighbours. There are four families on the island, besides ourselves, all are farmers on a small scale. I thank you on behalf of my family and myself for the *Health Magazine* you sent, too. Again thanking you for the papers, and wishing you the compliments of the season.

It was with pleasure we received the literature you sent, and we like it very much, and will welcome more at any time. Thank you for your kindness. We take great pleasure in passing on the papers, as all our family like them, too. They are all married and away from home, but visit us occasionally. We are glad to have the parcels, and like to read the papers very much, especially those on the topics of the Eastern Question. I have to be satisfied with a little corner of this earth, and help to keep the "lower lights" burning, as I am the only lighthouse keeper on this station. I trust in God and have a living faith in His love and mercy, and try to do my part in the station into which He has been pleased to call me. I now close, wishing you all the compliments of the season.

Honest Seekers

BROTHER J. Wordsworth, one of our New Zealand agents, writes thus of his experiences in helping some honest seekers after truth that he has met in his work:

"I am thankful that the Lord has spared me through another week and given me the opportunity of working for Him. Although this week's report does not show many orders taken, we remember that the Lord does not count success altogether in this way. Truly we need to work now as never before, as everything indicates that the end is near. May His love constrain us to go forward in His strength.

"On Monday, when putting in my delivery, I met a lady who took a "Great Controversy" from me. After delivering it we talked for some time on the condition of things at the present time. I explained our work to her more fully, and she was glad to know that young people are willing to take up such a work in visiting the homes of the people. I told her that I was planning to attend college in April, and that I was obtaining the means through the sale of this good book. She asked me what college I was planning to attend, and I told her it was a Seventh-day Adventist school. When leaving she gave me an order for "Daniel and Revelation" in the 15s. binding. The Lord is working upon hearts at this time, and we need to search for souls as those who must give account.

"A Mr. and Mrs. ——— are very much interested. Brother Coutts and I have been studying with them. On Friday we received a letter from them urging us to come and explain the tithing question, as they were very much perplexed about it. Pray for us that we may be given wisdom to present the truth to these dear souls.

"Last Sunday, Brother Coutts and I conducted a little meeting out in the field in the shade of some trees. There were about a dozen present. We opened with a hymn, and then Brother Coutts led in prayer, after which the writer presented the subject of the "Second Coming of Christ." We had a profitable time together, and trust that others present besides Mr. and Mrs. ——— may be led to think more seriously about these things."

Later Brother Wordsworth writes:

"Just a few additional lines which I know will interest you. Last evening I visited Mr. and Mrs. ——— and studied with them until about eleven. We studied the Sabbath question and other points, and they are convinced that the seventh day should be kept. Mrs. ——— is deeply interested and keeps reminding her husband of the truth of these things. She is anxious that they keep the Sabbath, and her mother is also of the same mind. The Spirit of the Lord is working, and I firmly believe that we shall see precious souls here accept this truth. Will you please send their copy of "Daniel and Revelation" up at once. They are anxious for it. Also I would like you to send some tracts on the Sabbath question."

A Work with a Future

PASTOR URIAH SMITH gave the following interesting report at the General Conference in 1889. Comparing the work at that time with former years, Brother Smith said:

"I often think of the time when Pastor Loughborough, myself, and a few others, in Rochester, New York, under the direction of Brother White, were preparing the first tracts to be sent out to the people. The instruments we had to use were a bradawl, a straight-edge, and a penknife. With the awl, Brother Loughborough would perforate the backs for stitching, the sisters would stitch them, and then with the straight-edge and the penknife, I would trim the rough edges on the top, front, and bottom. We blistered our hands in the operation, and often the tracts were not half so true and square in form as were the doctrines they taught.

"I often try to imagine what our emotions would have been, could we have been suddenly transported to this time, and looked upon these institutions and the wonderful facilities now provided for carrying on the work, and heard the reports we have heard here, and so have been brought face to face with the great advancement that this cause has made. I think we should have felt like exclaiming, 'It is enough; "now lettest Thou Thy servant depart in peace"!' But we have come to this time; the contrast is no less real and striking because it has taken a few years to accomplish it. But now we do not feel like departing just yet, because there is a future to this work."

The total value of literature sales during 1889 amounted to $500,000 (£100,000). Brother Smith was right, was he not, when he said, "There is a future to this work"? Our sales have now reached a total of over one and a half million dollars (three hundred thousand pounds) a year, yet notwithstanding this, we believe now as did Brother Smith in 1889, that there is yet a future to this work, and that it will continue to advance year by year.

N. Z. TOWN.

"WOULD you have your friend live a better life? Picture only that better life in your thoughts of him and never by word or look emphasize the opposite."

Talk Less; Pray More

To no people in the world was there ever committed a greater responsibility than rests upon Seventh-day Adventists. We are made the conservators of solemn and important truth. We are a part of a great religious movement which is extending to all the world. Weighty and perplexing problems confront us. We have to deal with large questions of finance, of plan, of policy. The various boards and committees of our conferences and institutions are perplexed at times beyond measure to know what to do to meet the growing demands of the work and the exigencies and emergencies that continually arise. We spend much time in counsel and discussion, but O, how little time comparatively do we spend in prayer!

We need to plan. We need to think, and to think hard over the questions with which we have to deal; but O, let us not plan without divine guidance! If half the time we spend in idle talk and theorizing were spent in the study of God's Word and earnest supplication, the results attained would amply justify the employment of these means in our work.

We need in our work to pray more and talk less. We need to place less dependence upon human reasoning, and reach out after the wisdom that comes from above. The guidance of the Holy Spirit is worth more than any human philosophy. A few moments spent in earnest supplication will accomplish more than any human devising.

F. M. W.

A Sufficiency Promised

"LIBERALITY, both in spiritual and in temporal things, is taught in the lesson of seed-sowing. The Lord says, 'Blessed are ye that sow beside all waters.' 'This I say, He that soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully.' To sow beside all waters means a continual imparting of God's gifts. It means giving wherever the cause of God or the needs of humanity demand our aid. This will not tend to poverty. The sower multiplies his seed by casting it away. So it is with those who are faithful in distributing God's gifts. By imparting they increase their blessings. God has promised them a sufficiency that they may continue to give."

The Sabbath

Again the evening hours draw on,
And six days of the week are gone;
Perplexities are tucked away
To sleep through all the Sabbath day,
The wheels of daily toiling cease
In reverence for this day of peace,
And thoughts unfettered soar above,
To view the greatness of God's love.

The chorus of the universe
Their great Creator's power rehearse;
For all the seraphs of the sky
Their holy, holy, holy, cry,
And dwellers of the planets land
The glory of the mighty God,
While saints of earth their voices raise
In solemn prayer and hymns of praise.

Now Israel afar and near
United in His courts appear,
To learn new truths at Jesus' feet,
And bow before the mercy-seat;
Then 'neath her vaulted canopy
They witness Nature's ecstasy.
So golden hours find sweet employ
In Sabbath rest and sacred joy.

Sublime the holy Sabbath day!
Too swift its moments pass away!
Its weekly benediction blest
Imparts a glimpse of heaven's rest;
For all who from their works refrain,
The blessed rest of God obtain.
And still the earth renewed shall see
The Sabbath kept eternally.

—*Worthie Harris Holden.*

Our Next Sabbath-school Lessons

FOR the past three years, beginning with the lessons on the life of Christ, we have had uniform lesson topics in all divisions in our Sabbath-schools. The subjects studied have been of special interest, and all have enjoyed the plan of having the same lessons in all divisions.

For various reasons we cannot well follow this plan all the time. We have a regular four-year course for the children and young people, consisting of two years in Old Testament history, one year on the life of Christ, six months on the Book of Acts, and six months on doctrinal, or topical, questions. As the children and young people pass from one division to another we can go over and over the same ground in a regular course, such as mentioned above; but all can see that we cannot take the senior division over and over the same four years'

course. So for a time we shall have to revert to the plan of having special lessons for the senior division.

Beginning with the next quarter, the intermediate and primary divisions will begin again the regular course. The lessons will begin in Genesis. A most excellent series of lessons has been provided, and we hope these studies will prove a great blessing to all in these divisions.

The senior division will begin a six months' study on the mediation of Christ, covering His work as priest in the heavenly sanctuary. These lessons, we feel sure, will be of special interest, and will prove very helpful at this particular time. Other good lessons are to follow.

We urge a study of the lessons, for we feel that there is a serious lack of real Bible study in our Sabbath-schools. Looking over the lesson for a short time is not *studying* the lesson. Many persons come up to the recitation of the lesson on the Sabbath having studied it very little. This is very sad indeed.

The cry is sometimes raised, "These lessons are too hard; why don't you give us something easy? Make them simple so we can understand them." This may be all right; but when something easy is called for in order to avoid the necessity of doing some hard studying, the request is very unfortunate. Complaint sometimes comes to the Sabbath-school Department that the lessons are too difficult, when the *real* difficulty is not with the lessons, but with the persons who have failed to study hard and long, and do not want to do so.

All our Sabbath-school lessons are *Bible lessons*. Questions are asked, and the exact Bible texts designated where the answers are to be found. Of course, there are deep things in the Bible in the unfolding of the mystery of godliness. We do not have much sympathy with the idea that we are to study *only* the simple, easy, surface truths of the Bible. *All* Scripture is for our instruction; and there are times when we should plunge out into the deep and let down the net; when some of the things which Peter says are "*hard* to be understood" should be considered. God put these things in the Bible for our instruction. But it will require study to unravel some of the things which "the angels desire to look into." The subject and manner of presenting it may be new, and some of the ideas different from the way we have looked at them. But do not argue, nor get discouraged, but *study*. The Bible is a mine of truth in which we must dig for the ore. The most valuable diamonds are not found with ease, lying on the surface, but after hard digging, *deep* down in the earth.

G. B. THOMPSON,
General Conference Secretary, Sabbath-school Department.

Sabbath-School Reports

For Quarter Ending December 31, 1912

Victoria

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Ballarat	58	40	£4 17 9
Beaufort	13	11	1 19 1
Bendigo	44	32	3 17 3
Benalla	30	16	3 9 4
Box Hill	18	13	3 10 0
Brighton	7	5	1 0 0½
Brunswick	54	39	4 3 7
Bunyip	15	14	2 14 0
Costerfield	8	8	1 3 0
Devenish	23	19	2 10 8½
Diamond Creek ...	17	13	2 8 3
Drouin	7	7	17 8
Geelong	24	16	2 14 10
Hawthorn	27	20	4 9 6½
Kooweerup	11	11	16 6½
Moonee Ponds	40	39	2 13 0
Moe	14	11	1 0 7
North Fitzroy	107	85	14 9 9
Numurkah	23	15	4 2 2½
Richmond	52	46	7 10 4
South Melbourne ...	29	22	6 2 0
Shepparton	50	36	4 7 5
Sassafras Gully... ...	6	6	1 5 0
Stawell	17	14	3 10 8
Warburton	117	93	21 9 6
Windsor	69	58	9 4 7
Williamstown	14	11	1 8 8
Warrowitne	16	15	1 6 1
Wangaratta	8	8	16 11
Whitfield	8	8	5 8
Yarraville	32	19	1 7 1½
Home Department ...	101	101	6 14 11
Totals	1038	851	£128 5 6

MRS. E. H. GATES, Sec.

Tasmania

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Bismark	68	37	£4 5 0½
Bishopsbourne	12	11	3 16 5
Campbell Town ...	4	2	1 14 7
Devonport	24	16	2 4 5
Glen Huon	32	25	3 3 3½
Hobart	33		
Launceston	12	11	1 17 11½
Meander West	7	6	11 0
New Norfolk	16	14	1 9 7
Port Esperance ...	10	6	1 4 0
St. Mary's	11	11	5 7
Tasman's Peninsula ...	9	7	17 2
Home Department ...	47	47	5 8 4½
Glenorchy Camp ...			11 16 5
Totals	285	193	£38 13 10

MRS. E. H. GATES, Sec.

New South Wales

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Avondale	237	154	£21 18 7
Ashfield	35	25	3 1 0
Arcadia	24	18	2 15 8
Arncliffe	35	22	4 1 3½
Auburn	33	24	2 18 6
Chatswood	19	14	3 14 7
Cobar	4	4	10 0
Corndale	35	23	7 8 9
Cowra	7	6	13 0
Drummoyne	16	14	1 1 9½
Deniliquin	9	7	1 18 1
Eugowra	36	22	3 16 0
Epping	20	15	2 18 0
Fairy Meadow	33	25	1 6 0
Guildford	28	19	1 15 2
Grafton	5	4	1 1 0
Hamilton	25	10	2 7 4
Hornsby	37	23	2 9 0½
Hickey's Creek ...	16	10	12 4
Harden	23	13	3 16 6½
Kellyville	12	11	2 7 11
Kempsey	46	17	2 15 6
Lower Bucca	9	7	1 0 0
Lithgow	22	17	3 5 0
Maitland	19	12	1 19 0½
Moss Vale	4	4	17 0
Marrickville	61	36	3 18 10½
Muswellbrook	5	3	18 2½
North Sydney	54	36	6 4 9½
Orange	16	9	18 10
Ourimbah	41	31	10 19 4
Prospect	14	12	13 3
Parkes	27	21	6 5 8½
Parramatta	46	35	3 12 1½
Paterson	12	7	2 6 7
Quirindi	19	15	1 19 7½
Stanmore	65	45	9 12 11½
Surry Hills	4	3	11 6
Tarana	21	18	1 13 5
Wallsend	30	11	1 1 0
Wahroonga	109	82	15 5 6
Wellington	27	13	2 0 0
Woollahra	23	13	2 2 7
Canvasser's Division ...	5	5	12 3
Home Department ...	125	125	6 15 8
Camp Meeting			26 11 2
Totals	1463	1040	£186 5 6

MISS L. M. BREE, Sec.

South Australia

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Adelaide	69	41	£7 1 4
Broken Hill	26	18	1 16 11
Burra	6	5	7 6
Black Swamp	32	20	
Goolwa	11	9	8 9
Gawler	29	27	7 1 7
Hamley Bridge... ...	10	5	8 0
Jamestown	6	4	1 0 0
Kadina	4	3	1 0 0
Kensington	51	35	11 9 3
Kapunda	7	7	17 6
Mount Gambier ...	45	30	4 3 7
Paramoo	9	7	19 6
Prospect	60	50	7 9 4
Penola	14	9	1 0 1
Quorn	6	5	3 12 10
Woodville	19	14	2 5 5
Yorketown	4	4	10 0
Home Department ...	50	50	3 4 9
Totals	458	343	£54 16 4

MISS ETHEL R. CARTER, Sec.

West Australia

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Albany	4	3	£ 1 16 3
Bridgetown	15	11	3 8 3
Bookarn	16	12	6 8 8½
Bidellia Donelly	21	16	2 3 1
Canning Mills	3	3	5 0½
Capel	27	21	2 5 0½
Cookernup	39	30	11 0 7½
Fremantle	64	50	8 19 10
Geraldton	6	5	2 5 0
Heidelberg	90	79	14 15 8
Jumperding	18	15	1 15 4
Kalgoorlie	19	16	3 8 11
Midland	40	34	4 10 1
Narrogin	27	23	2 4 11
Northam	20	15	4 2 5
Osborne Park	14	8	1 7 7½
Perth	72	63	13 15 0
Spring Valley	17	14	1 12 0
Springdale	6	5	2 14 2½
Upper Preston	19	17	5 0 4½
Warren	4	4	1 1 1
Wooroloo	3	3	7 6
York	12	10	2 19 9
Home Department	104	104	15 2 3
Totals	660	560	£112 14 10½

MISS CONSTANCE M. RULE, Sec.

Queensland

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Brisbane South	65	65	£11 2 3½
Calliope	15	12	1 6 3
Coolabunia	20	17	1 19 5½
Gatton	42	35	5 8 1
Goombungee	16	15	1 5 0
Murgon	39	35	4 5 3
Mackay	5	5	13 0
Rockhampton	22	14	3 2 8
Toowoomba	34	26	4 11 4
Townsville	9	6	3 4 6
Queenton	27	...	8 1 11
Home Department	45	45	11 1 10
Totals	339	270	£50 18 7

MISS C. J. COZENS, Sec.

Mission Fields

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Cook Islands	26	21	£3 13 4
Fiji	310	236	10 19 1½
Friendly Islands	13	13	4 5 0
Lord Howe Island	24	24	5 7 0
New Guinea	6	6	3 12 2
New Hebrides	4	4	1 10 0
Norfolk Island	52	38	4 13 10
Pitcairn Island	138	136	
Samoa	13	11	4 11 10
Society Islands	49	33	5 13 1
Totals	635	514	£44 5 4½

New Zealand

Name of School	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
Cambridge	70	60	£7 11 6
Christchurch	96	53	12 7 7½
Dunedin	13	20	4 3 3
Ebetahuna	10	9	4 8 3
Epsom	23	16	4 0 0
Gisborne	31	26	4 9 4
Hastings	30	23	6 11 2
Kaeo	8	7	14 6
Napier	25	20	7 4 3
Nelson	8	6	2 5 4
New Plymouth	9	4	1 16 2
Norsewood	4	3	1 2 6
Ormondville	11	8	2 10 8
Pahiatua	4	4	1 4 9
Palmerston North	28	25	4 10 5½
Paremata	12	11	2 8 9
Parkhurst	13	11	2 6 3
Petone	24	24	3 10 3½
Ponsonby	103	80	21 4 7
Timaru	15	12	1 13 8
Tolaga Bay	28	22	1 10 9
Waihou	18	13	2 12 11
Wanganui	17	12	2 15 2
Wellington	43	31	7 9 8
Woodville	8	6	2 0 9
Home Department	151	151	11 2 9
Totals	709	658	£124 14 1½

MISS E. M. GRAHAM, Sec.

Total Summary

Name of State	Present Membership	Average Attendance	Total Contributions to Missions
New South Wales	1463	1040	£186 5 6
New Zealand	709	658	124 14 1½
Queensland	339	230	50 18 7
South Australia	458	343	54 16 4
Tasmania	285	193	38 13 10
Victoria	1638	851	128 5 6
West Australia	660	560	112 14 10½
Mission Fields	635	514	44 5 4½
Totals	5607	4389	£740 14 1½

For the Nine Island Mission	£633 8 4
For the Fiji Tent Mission	£107 5 9½
	£740 14 1½

Strength in Weakness

It is no dream, great Comforter,
But very truth to me,
That all earth's strengthless, fainting ones
May be made strong in Thee.

The years have taught me many things;
But none so sure as this,
That shelter, solace, joy, and strength
Are always where God is.

—*Selected.*

THIS is the feeling that gives a man true courage—the feeling that he has a work to do at all costs; the sense of duty.—*Kingsley.*

When Prayer Fails

PRAYER at its best can never take a secondary place in life. When prayer has become secondary or incidental, it has lost its power. Those who are conspicuously men of prayer are those who use prayer as they use food, or air, or light, or money. They never attempt to get along without it. It is part of the provision and currency of their life. They would count themselves starved or bankrupt if they should attempt to live a prayerless twenty-four hours. Many of us believe in prayer, and avail ourselves of it as a sort "top dressing" to our lives, a desirable and helpful accompaniment to our own efforts, and nothing more. The result is that it never becomes anything more. And we live in poverty.—*Sunday School Times.*

Obituaries

TONGE.—On November 3, 1912, at his residence, South Fremantle, Brother Peter Jones Tonge, after a long and painful illness, fell asleep in Jesus. Brother Tonge was born in Warrington, England, and emigrated to Australia in 1882. He located in South Australia, and embraced present truth in Broken Hill in 1902 under Pastor Rogers' labours. He removed to West Australia and connected with the Fremantle Church in 1909, of which church he remained an active member until the day of his death. He leaves a widow and three grown-up children to mourn their loss. We laid him to rest in the Fremantle Cemetery, there to await the call of the great Life-giver on the resurrection morn. Brother Tonge was a consistent advocate of present truth, and he died with a firm trust in Christ as His Redeemer. The funeral services were conducted by the writer.

C. P. MICHAELS.

MAHER.—We regret that we have to record the death of two dear little children from an Adventist home at Sodwalls, New South Wales. Eileen May, aged four years and four months, took ill on January 14, and passed away after an illness of just twenty-six hours. That same day, Wednesday, Arthur John, aged two years and three months, took ill and died at 3 o'clock Friday morning, acute gastric enteritis being the cause of their deaths. These babes were the children of Brother and Sister Maher, who in deep sorrow have parted with their dearly loved children, but recognize that it will not be long before their angels who watch over their sleeping place will take them from the opened grave. The elder of the Kendale Church, Mr. W. Hawken, conducted the service at Mount Olive Cemetery, where these two lambs of God's fold were buried on the same day, side by side in one grave. We extend to those bereaved parents and relatives our heart-felt sympathy.

E. M. JAMES.

Australasian Record

THE OFFICIAL ORGAN OF THE
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OF SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTISTS
"Miznah," Wahroonga, N.S.W., Australia

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WHEN your copy of the RECORD comes in a red wrapper, it indicates that your subscription is expiring, and that your renewal is kindly solicited. Please order promptly, that no copies may be missed.

BROTHER R. K. PIPER writes: The calendars for 1913 issued with our native paper, the *Tuatua-Mou*, were well received, and were sought for by the people, even the Government officials remarked upon their excellency."

PASTOR E. H. GATES is attending the South Australian camp-meeting in addition to those mentioned last week as representing the general work. He writes that the Victorian camp-meeting was one of the largest and best ever held in that conference. One of the workers in attendance is sending a report of this meeting.

"THE Oroua Missionary School" is the name chosen for the new school in course of erection near Longburn, New Zealand. Oroua is the name of the district in which the school is located, and is a Maori name meaning "twice entered." As this is the second place in New Zealand selected for the location of our school, the meaning seems a singularly appropriate one.

THE Melbourne Cafe business is making excellent progress in its new premises and under its new management. They have reached the 1,000 per week mark in attendance. The second week in February the Sydney Cafe made a record, having had 1,533 in attendance. They have been forced to tear down one of their store-rooms to make room for the people.

FROM a letter written by Brother Harold Sharp we learn that he has been appointed secretary and treasurer of the Malaysian Mission and is to have charge of the work in Singapore, where they will be located at 12 Dhoby Ghaut in that city. Brother and Sister Sharp were at one time engaged in church-school work in Australia, and have for about two years been doing self-supporting teaching work in Java. They have been prospered in this work, but although it means a sacrifice from a financial point of view, they are very glad to answer this call to connect with the organized work.

THE following letter is from a man to whom a copy of "Great Controversy" was delivered in the New Zealand Conference some time ago: "I see by a tract called "Armageddon" that you are the agents for the Signs Publishing Company in Australia. This tract was given to me by your canvasser for the book "Great Controversy." I find the book is very enlightening on the Scriptures, and I wish to make presents to two friends, so I will ask you to send me two copies of the book, for which I think I paid 12s. 6d. I would like also three dozen of the tract "Armageddon." I want to subscribe for the *Signs of the Times*.

A SISTER in one of the Sydney churches who has been passing through a trying experience, and was feeling somewhat depressed in consequence, resolved that she would take some copies of *The Outlook* with her as she was making some business calls. She also entered into conversation with some whom she met in travelling, which resulted in awakening a keen interest in the magazine and the truths it advocates Altogether in a short time and with little effort she disposed of seventeen copies of *The Outlook*, and reported feeling wonderfully cheered up by these good experiences. This sister heartily recommends her prescription to all who feel depressed through ill-health or because of the roughness of the way. Try it.

A YOUNG lady has just taken her stand in Wellington, New Zealand, as the result of a copy of "Great Controversy" being placed in her home recently by one of our agents. In reference to this case Pastor Westerman writes: "This young lady purchased a copy of "Great Controversy" from Brother Rampton, who left me her address. I have visited her several times, leaving tracts with her. She did not seem particularly interested at first, but during the past month she has been overtaken by an illness, during which time she has read "Great Controversy" through from cover to cover, and has resolved to obey the Lord. She wishes more literature on various points of our faith. Although inclined to be worldly before, her illness has afforded opportunity for reflection, and she now feels her need of a Saviour."

On Board the "Orvieto"

WE are having a splendid trip over so far; the *Orvieto* is a fine boat. When we were two days out we informed the steward that we were vegetarians, and to our surprise he told us that the head cook was interested in vegetarianism. I immediately sent my card to him and requested an interview, which was granted, and we have become very good friends. I invited him up to the Melbourne Cafe to dinner, and this he enjoyed very much. He promised to cook specially for us, and so far he is keeping his word. This man has had a very wide experience, talks French fluently, and has been in many of the largest places in Europe. He has twelve cooks under him (this boat is capable of carrying 1,800 including the crew). He often writes articles for the English vegetarian papers, and is now publishing a vegetarian cookery book. I have invited him to the sanitarium when I return to Sydney. I sincerely hope that I shall be able to make this trip a very profitable one. I appreciate God's love and goodness to us. I shall be glad to get back again to the work I love so much. G. S. FISHER.

For Sale at Avondale

AS A going concern, fruit and green-grocery business, comprising large shop with dwelling attached,—five rooms and kitchen and conveniences. Over an acre of orchard and garden. Stables and fowl run. Good living for energetic man. Full particulars from Geo. Searle, Avondale, Cooranbong, New South Wales.